

**【9.2| BARRON'S】 Feeding AI: Data From A Bankrupt Airline
Is Now Worth Millions 喂养 AI：破产航空公司的数据现值数百万
美金**

难度评级：★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之经济学系列】

今日文章脉络：

人工智能竞赛催生了数据市场 (Para. 1)



谷歌高价拍下某破产航空公司的内部数据，
而这只是冰山一角 (Para. 2-3)



人工智能大模型对于数据需求巨大 (Para. 4)



上市公司等各企业都在考虑是否授权数据 (Para. 5-6)



重建和使用数据中心的代价高昂，不如对外购买 (Para. 7)



数据市场的发展前景一片大好 (Para. 8-13)



但判断何时卖出数据尤为关键，
用户隐私是一大因素 (Para. 14-16)



此外也有人忧虑，有了数据加持，
人工智能或成为新的对手 (Para. 17-18)



作者认为，人工智能主导是大势，不可避免 (Para. 19)

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

The **race** to build the most advanced artificial-intelligence tools has **spawned** a new market for real world data. It comes with both opportunities and **pitfalls** for investors.

- ♦ **bankrupt a.** /'bæŋkrʌpt/ without enough money to pay what you owe 破产；倒闭【考研大纲词汇】

SYN insolvent

They went bankrupt in 1993. 他们于 1993 年破产。

- ♦ **race n.** ~ (for sth/to do sth) a situation in which a number of people, groups, organizations, etc. are competing, especially for political power or to achieve sth first 竞争；角逐【考研大纲词汇】

the race for the presidency 总统竞选

- ♦ **spawn v.** /spɔ:n/ (often disapproving) to cause sth to develop or be produced 引发；引起；导致；造成

The band's album spawned a string of hit singles. 这支乐队的专辑繁衍出一连串走红的单曲唱片。

- ♦ **pitfall n.** a danger or difficulty, especially one that is hidden or not obvious at first 危险；困难；（尤指）陷阱，隐患

the potential pitfalls of buying a house 购买房屋可能遇到的
圈套

围绕开发最先进人工智能工具的竞争催生了现实数据这一
新市场。这对投资者而言既蕴含机遇，也暗藏风险。

【Para.2】

Earlier this month, Google won an **auction** to purchase Spirit Airlines' software code, internal messages, and financial and operational data for \$10 million, according to **filings** from Spirit's bankruptcy **proceedings**. Google hopes to use the data to improve its products and AI models, a **spokesperson** said.

- ♦ **auction** n. a public event at which things are sold to the person who offers the most money for them 拍卖【考研大纲词汇】

an auction of paintings 绘画拍卖会

- ♦ **filing** n. /'faɪlɪŋ/ the act of putting documents, letters, etc. into a file 存档；归档 something that is placed in an official record 存档档案；归档记录【考研大纲词汇】

a bankruptcy filing 破产档案

- ♦ **proceeding** n. /prə'si:diŋ/ (formal) [C, usually pl.]~ (against sb) (for sth) the process of using a court to settle a

disagreement or to deal with a complaint 诉讼；诉讼程序

【考研大纲词汇】

bankruptcy/divorce/extradition, etc. proceedings 破产、离婚、引渡等诉讼

- ♦ **spokesperson** n. /'spəʊkspɜːsn/ (pl.-persons or -people) ~ (for sb/sth) a person who speaks on behalf of a group or an organization 发言人

据 Spirit 航空公司破产程序的文件显示，本月早些时候，谷歌在拍卖中以 1000 万美元的价格竞得 Spirit 航空公司的软件代码、内部通信以及财务和运营数据。谷歌一位发言人表示，该公司希望利用这些数据来改进其产品和人工智能模型。

【Para.3】

That \$10 million **outlay** for a **busted** airline's data is just **the tip of the iceberg**. AI companies are **vacuuming** up corporate information of all sorts—a process that has **taken on** greater importance now that **scrapping** the internet has become more legally **fraught**.

- ♦ **outlay** n. /'aʊtleɪ/ ~ (on sth) the money that you have to spend in order to start a new project (启动新项目的) 开支，费用

The business quickly repaid the initial outlay on advertising.

这家公司很快偿付了初期的广告费。

- ◆ **busted a.** 破产的
- ◆ **the tip of the iceberg** *idiom* only a small part of a much larger problem (问题的) 冰山一角
- ◆ **vacuum v.** /'vækju:m/ If you vacuum something, you clean it using a vacuum cleaner. 用真空吸尘器清洁

I vacuumed the carpets today. 我今天用吸尘器清洁地毯了。

- ◆ **take on** *phrase* If something takes on a new appearance or quality, it develops that appearance or quality. 呈现

Believing he had only a year to live, his writing took on a feverish intensity. 他认为自己只有一年能活了，他的文字呈现出一种极度的狂热。

- ◆ **scrap v.** /skræp/ [often passive] to cancel or get rid of sth that is no longer practical or useful 废弃；取消；抛弃；报废

【考研大纲词汇】

They had been forced to scrap plans for a new school building. 他们已被迫撤销了建筑新校舍的计划。

- ◆ **fraught a.** /frɔ:t/ causing or feeling worry and anxiety 焦虑的；忧虑的；担心的

SYN tense

She looked/sounded fraught. 她愁容满面；她的话音显出忧虑。

一家破产航空公司的数据能卖出 1000 万美元，这还只是冰

山一角。人工智能公司正在大量吸纳各类企业信息——随着从互联网上抓取数据在法律上变得越来越棘手，这一过程如今变得愈发重要。

【Para.4】

The demand for data is linked to how AI large-language models are created and **refined**. The computer systems **ingest** huge **volumes** of human information and use it to mimic human processes, such as writing reports, **interpreting** and responding to messages, and making recommendations. More data means more examples the model can pull from.

- ♦ **refine v.** If something such as a process, theory, or machine is refined, it is improved by having small changes made to it. 完善【考研大纲词汇】

Surgical techniques are constantly being refined. 外科手术技术正在不断得到完善。

- ♦ **ingest v.** When animals or plants ingest a substance, they take it into themselves, by eating or absorbing it. 摄取; 吸收
...side effects occurring in fish that ingest this substance. ...
在吃了此物质的鱼身上产生的副作用。

- ♦ **volume n.** The volume of something is the amount of it that there is. 量【考研大纲词汇】

Senior officials will be discussing how the volume of sales might be reduced. 高级官员们将讨论如何才能减少销售量。

- ♦ **interpret v.** If you interpret something in a particular way, you decide that this is its meaning or significance. 解释【考研大纲词汇】

The fact that they had decided to come was interpreted as a positive sign. 他们已经决定要来的事实可被解释为一个积极的信号。

对数据的需求与人工智能大型语言模型的构建和优化密切相关。计算机系统会摄入海量的人类信息，并利用这些信息模拟人类的处理流程，例如撰写报告、解读和回复消息以及提供建议。数据越多，模型可借鉴的样本就越多。

【Para.5】

In response, public companies are **weighing** whether to license their data. And **start-ups** are opening marketplaces through which smaller enterprises can sell everything from contracts to email **threads**.

- ♦ **weigh v.** If you weigh the facts about a situation, you consider them very carefully before you make a decision, especially by comparing the various facts involved. 权衡【考研大纲词汇】

She weighed her options. 她在各种选择间权衡斟酌。

- ♦ **start-up n.** a company that is just beginning to operate, especially an Internet company 刚成立的公司，新企业（尤指互联网公司）
- ♦ **thread n.** (computing 计) a series of connected messages on a message board on the Internet which have been sent by different people (互联网留言板上帖子的) 系列相关信息，链式消息【考研大纲词汇】

作为回应，上市公司正在权衡是否要授权其数据。而初创企业则正在开设交易平台，让小型企业能够通过这些平台出售从合同到电子邮件往来记录等各类数据。

【Para.6】

“Companies are sitting on decades of records that show how real work gets done, and that data is now some of the most valuable material for training and evaluating AI,” said a spokesperson from Mercor, an AI data start-up that made a \$7.5 million **bid** in the Spirit auction.

- ♦ **bid n.** ~ (for sth) an offer by a person or a business company to pay a particular amount of money for sth 买方的出价【考研大纲词汇】

At the auction (= a public sale where things are sold to the

person who offers most) , the highest bid for the picture was £ 200. 拍卖会上, 这幅画的最高出价为 200 英镑。

“企业掌握着数十年的记录, 这些记录展示了实际工作是如何完成的, 而这些数据如今已成为训练和评估人工智能的最有价值的素材之一, ” 人工智能数据初创公司 Mercor 的一位发言人表示。该公司在 Spirit 的拍卖中出价 750 万美元。

【Para.7】

The economics make perfect sense. The five largest cloud providers are spending a combined \$800 billion in capital **expenditures** in 2026 to build data centers, and AI labs are paying hundreds of billions to use the facilities. Millions of dollars—with an “M”—mean very little to them when creating new AI tools, but that money can be a **game-changer** for data sellers.

- ♦ **expenditure** n. /ɪk'spendɪtʃə(r)/ the act of spending or using money; an amount of money spent 花费; 消费; 费用; 开支【考研大纲词汇】
a reduction in public/government/military expenditure 公共/政府/军费开支的削减
- ♦ **game changer** n. a newly introduced element or factor that changes an existing situation or activity in a significant way

新出现的能影响整个局势的变量

从经济角度来看，这完全合乎逻辑。五大云服务提供商在2026年合计投入8000亿美元资本，用于建设数据中心，而人工智能实验室也在支付数千亿美元来使用这些设施。对于开发新的人工智能工具而言，数百万美元——这里指的是“M”开头的百万——对它们来说微不足道，但这笔钱却可能彻底改变数据卖家的命运。

【Para.8】

The market appears to be **picking up**. In January, Cloudflare acquired HumanNative, a marketplace connecting content creators with AI developers. Two months later, News Corp, the owner of Barron's publisher Dow Jones, **struck** a licensing deal with Meta Platforms, where the publisher sold access to its content for \$50 million a year.

- ♦ **pick up** *phrase* self trade or the economy of a country picks up, it improves. (贸易、经济) 改善【考研大纲词汇】
Industrial production is beginning to pick up. 工业生产正在开始好转。
- ♦ **strike v.** to make an agreement with sb in which both sides have an advantage 达成（对双方都有利的）协议【考研大纲词汇】

这一市场似乎越发火热。今年 1 月，Cloudflare 收购了 HumanNative——这是一个将内容创作者与 AI 开发者连接起来的市场平台。两个月后，《巴伦周刊》出版商道琼斯（隶属于新闻集团）与 Meta Platforms 达成了一项许可协议，该出版商以每年 5000 万美元的价格出售其内容的访问权限。

【Para.9】

For smaller companies and even individuals looking to sell their data, an **array** of start-ups are **emerging** to broker deals.

- ♦ **array** n. [usually sing.] a group or collection of things or people, often one that is large or impressive 大堆；大群；大量【考研大纲词汇】

a vast array of bottles of different shapes and sizes 一大批形状大小不一的瓶子

- ♦ **emerge** v. ~ (as sth) to start to exist; to appear or become known 露头；显现；显露【考研大纲词汇】

After the elections opposition groups began to emerge. 经过选举，反对派开始露头。

对于希望出售数据的小型公司甚至个人而言，一批初创企业正应运而生，致力于促成相关交易。

【Para.10】

Over a recent 11-day **stretch**, micro1, an AI data venture, **committed** more than \$20 million to license operational data, said CEO Ali Ansari in a social media post this past week.

- ♦ **stretch n.** a continuous period of time (连续的) 一段时间

【考研大纲词汇】

SYN spell

They worked in four-hour stretches. 他们工作四小时一班。

- ♦ **commit v.** to spend money or time on sth/sb 花 (钱或时间)

【考研大纲词汇】

The council has committed large amounts of money to housing projects. 市政会在住宅项目上投入了大量资金。

人工智能数据初创公司 micro1 的首席执行官阿里·安萨里 (Ali Ansari) 上周在社交媒体上发文称，在最近的 11 天内，该公司已承诺投入超过 2000 万美元用于获取运营数据的授权。

【Para.11】

Investors can get in on the action, too. Barron's made two stock picks last month based on the growing value of AI training data.

投资者也可以参与其中。《巴伦周刊》上个月基于人工智能训练数据价值的不断增长，推荐了两只股票。

【Para.12】

Reddit struck agreements with OpenAI and Google in 2024 to license conversations from its forums, bringing in an estimated \$60 million a year from each lab. The social-media platform is now in **negotiations** with Google, and some investors and analysts expect a much larger deal.

- ♦ **negotiation** n. /nɪˌɡəʊʃiˈeɪʃn/ [usually pl. U] formal discussion between people who are trying to reach an agreement 谈判；磋商；协商
peace/trade/wage, etc. negotiations 和谈、贸易洽谈、工资谈判等

Reddit 于 2024 年与 OpenAI 和谷歌达成协议，授权其使用论坛中的对话数据，预计从每家实验室每年可获得 6000 万美元收入。该社交媒体平台目前正与谷歌进行谈判，部分投资者和分析师预计将达成一笔规模更大的交易。

【Para.13】

John Wiley & Sons, a publisher of academic and technical literature, has also **racked up big-name** customers. The company's licensing agreements with leading AI developers have generated more than \$110

million since 2024. It also has collaborations with Amazon Web Services, Microsoft, Anthropic, and others.

- ♦ **rack up phrase** If a business racks up profits, losses, or sales, it makes a lot of them. If a sportsman, sportswoman, or team racks up wins, they win a lot of games or races. 大量获得 (利润); 严重遭受 (损失); (体育中) 多次赢得 (比赛)

Lower rates mean that firms are more likely to rack up profits in the coming months. 更低的费率意味着各公司更有可能在未来的几个月里获得大量利润。

- ♦ **big-name a.** 知名的; 出名的

学术与技术文献出版商约翰·威利父子公司 (John Wiley & Sons) 也已积累了众多知名客户。自 2024 年以来, 该公司与领先的人工智能开发商达成的授权协议已创收超过 1.1 亿美元。此外, 它还与亚马逊网络服务 (AWS)、微软、Anthropic 等公司建立了合作关系。

【Para.14】

The key for investors, and indeed companies, is **pinpointing** when data sales may do more harm than good.

- ♦ **pinpoint v.** to find and show the exact position of sb/sth or the exact time that sth happened 明确指出, 确定 (位置或时

间)

He was able to pinpoint on the map the site of the medieval village. 他能在地图上准确找出那个中世纪村庄的位置。

对投资者乃至企业而言，关键在于准确判断数据销售何时会弊大于利。

【Para.15】

Privacy is one challenge, particularly for consumer-facing businesses. Opera, the Norwegian web-browser company, has resisted selling data on those **grounds**.

- ♦ **ground n.** for sth/for doing sth a good or true reason for saying, doing or believing sth 充分的理由；根据【考研大纲词汇】

The case was dismissed on the grounds that there was not enough evidence. 此案以缺乏足够的证据为由被驳回。

隐私是一个挑战，特别是对于面向消费者的企业而言。挪威网络浏览器公司 Opera 正是基于这些理由，一直拒绝出售用户数据。

【Para.16】

“If we lose the users’ trust, if they think, ‘Oh, if we use the Opera browser, then they’re actually going to sell our data,’ then it’s probably not a wise move,” said Frode Jacobsen, chief financial officer at Opera, at an investor conference in January.

“如果我们失去了用户的信任，如果他们认为 ‘哦，如果我们使用 Opera 浏览器，他们实际上就会出售我们的数据’，那么这可能并不是一个明智之举，” Opera 首席财务官弗罗德·雅各布森 (Frode Jacobsen) 在今年 1 月的一次投资者大会上表示。

【Para.17】

Disruption by AI is the other threat. If the labs use a company’s **proprietary** information to build something better, or at least more popular, they could **siphon** away demand.

- ♦ **proprietary** a. /prəˈpraɪətri/ [usually before noun] (of goods 商品) made and sold by a particular company and protected by a registered trademark 专卖的；专营的；专利的【考研大纲词汇】
a proprietary medicine 专卖药品
- ♦ **siphon** v. (informal) to remove money from one place and move it to another, especially dishonestly or illegally (尤指

私自或非法) 抽走, 转移 (钱)

SYN divert

She has been accused of siphoning off thousands of pounds from the company into her own bank account. 她被指控把公司的几千英镑转移到了自己的账户里。

人工智能带来的颠覆是另一项威胁。如果这些实验室利用公司的专有信息开发出更优秀、或者至少更受欢迎的产品，它们可能会分流需求。

【Para.18】

“Our data is really the crown jewels of the future,” said Gary Morrison, CEO of hostel booking platform Hostelworld Group, in a conference call last month. “It is everything that we know about **profiles**, about bookings, about events, about people you’re meeting, what you’re talking about.”

♦ **profile** n. a description of sb/sth that gives useful information 概述；简介；传略【考研大纲词汇】

a job/employee profile 工作/雇员简介

“我们的数据确实是未来的‘皇冠明珠’，”青年旅舍预订平台 Hostelworld Group 的首席执行官加里·莫里森在上个月的一次电话会议上表示。“这包括我们所掌握的一切：用户画像、预订信息、活动详情、客户将结识的人，以及客户谈论的

话题。”

【Para.19】

But companies like Hostelworld, and indeed Reddit and John Wiley, will have to survive in an AI-dominated world whether they like it or not. That means many more executives will have to decide how much “the crown jewels” are worth.

但像 Hostelworld 这样，乃至 Reddit 和约翰·威利（John Wiley）这样的公司，无论愿意与否，都必须在人工智能主导的世界中生存下去。这意味着将有更多高管不得不去判断这些“皇冠明珠”究竟价值几何。

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➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 3) AI companies are vacuuming up corporate information of all sorts—a process that has taken on greater importance now that scraping the internet has become more legally fraught.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 3. AI companies are vacuuming up corporate information of all sorts—a process that has taken on greater importance now that scraping the internet has become more legally fraught. 人工智能公司正在大量吸纳各类企业信息——随着从互联网上抓取数据在法律上变得越来越棘手，这一过程如今变得愈发重要。

主句

AI companies are vacuuming up corporate information

主语 谓语 宾语

定语从句

of all sorts—a process that has taken on

定语 同位语 从句主语 谓语

原因状语从句

greater importance now that scraping the internet

宾语 (引导词) 从句主语

has become more legally fraught.

系语 表语

句子分析：

主句：

主语-AI companies; 谓语-are vacuuming up (vacuum up sth “像吸尘器一样吸走.....” 这里指人工智能公司大肆吸收各种企业信息); 宾语-corporate information; 定语-of all sorts;

同位语-a process (指代前面提到的 vacuuming up...);

定语从句, 修饰 process:

从句主语-that; 谓语-has taken on; 宾语-greater importance (take on greater importance 是相对于 be increasingly important 更为正式的表达);

原因状语从句:

(引导词) -now that (“既然.....” , 例: Now that the kids have left home we've got a lot of extra space. 孩子们都离开家了, 我们住着就更宽绰了。); 从句主语-scraping the internet; 系语-has become; 表语-more legally fraught (fraught a. “令人忧虑的”, legally fraught 可以理解为 “法律上让人烦恼或感到棘手的”) .

➤ 写作积累

Para.6 Companies are **sitting on** decades of records that show how real work gets done,

sit on sth 是较为形象的一个短语，字面意思为“坐在.....上”，暗指“压着不用、持有（某物）却不加以利用或处理”，补充例句：

- ◆ They have been sitting on my application for a month now.他们压着我的申请不办有一个月了。
- ◆ We are sitting on too much inventory that we can't sell. 我们积压了太多卖不掉的库存。

原文这里则是指各家公司“占有那么多工作数据，（却不能充分利用）”

类似表达：

- ◆ table/shelve sth v. “搁置”，King County has shelved plans to build a driving range. 金郡已搁置了建造一个高尔夫练习场的计划。
- ◆ let sth gather dust *phrase* “让.....积灰/闲置”，The idea is for people not to be selfish by keeping a book to gather dust on a shelf at home. 这个理念是，人们不要把书搁在家里书架上积灰，这样做是很自私的行为。

Para.18 Our data is really **the crown jewels** of the future
the crown jewels 字面意思 “王冠; 权杖” 一般用来喻指 “极为珍贵/关键的资源”，例：In our lineup of health care products, the Cosmetics division is our crown jewel. 在我们生产卫生保健产品的一系列部门中，化妆品部是最具竞争力的拳头部门。

有类似比喻用法的名词短语还包括：

- ◆ Holy grail “圣杯”，喻指 “终极追求、梦寐以求的目标（未必已拥有）”，The discovery is being hailed as the Holy Grail of astronomy. 这个发现被认为是为天文学圆了梦。
- ◆ Gold mine “金矿”，喻指 “能持续带来巨大收益的宝藏”，This restaurant is a potential gold mine. 这家餐馆很可能是棵摇钱树。